making BIMSTEC an alternative to SAARC look far from realistic.

The enthusiasm raised in India–Nepal relations started withering away, and relations have suffered a serious slide. Modi's proposed visit to the disturbed Terai region in November 2014 could not take place in view of Kathmandu's dilly-dallying. India's diplomatic assertion in Nepal to make it adopt a more inclusive Constitution incorporating the aspirations of marginalised social groups like Madhes, Dalits (untouchables), women, and Janjatis (tribals) were frustrated. This led India to awkwardly intervene through the despatch of Foreign Secretary Jaishankar as the Prime Minister's special envoy in September 2015, soon after the Constitution had been adopted by the Constituent Assembly. This clearly backfired on the opposition by the CPM (UML).[13] In response, India was seen blessing the candidature of Nepali Congress (NC) leader Sushil Koirala against UML leader K. P. Sharma Oli as Prime Minister. This was contrary to the prior understanding between the NC and the UML. Oli's decisive victory administered a strong snub to this Indian move. Following this, India imposed undeclared restrictions on the movement of essential goods to Nepal from the Indian side. This led to serious difficulties for ordinary Nepalese, who all became extremely resentful of the Indian move and condemned it as an "economic blockade." Nepal's new Prime Minister Oli reacted by mobilising the people against India's interference and succeeded in turning Nepali nationalism against India. He also invoked Chinese support to seek alternative trade and transit routes, thus facilitating China's drive to make strategic inroads into Nepal through the offer of infrastructure projects (under the Belt and Road Initiative) and political and economic support.[14] This has greatly boosted China's intrusion into the South Asian strategic space. What India faces in Nepal is a robust anti-